

Lecture 8: Sentiment Analysis — Lecture Notes

Speaker notes for each slide in `Lecture_8.Rmd` / `Lecture_8.html`, in presentation order. Where a slide poses a question for the class (Wooclap, "?", "Think Pair Share"), the intended answer or discussion points are given. Notes also flag how each slide connects to earlier/later ones, since several terms (sentiment, opinion, indirect/fact-implied opinion) are deliberately picked up again later in the deck.

1. The Little Prince example

Opens with two short reviews of *The Little Prince*, annotated with pros (Educational, Fun, Price, Funny) and one con (Readability). Don't over-explain yet — the point is just to let students see real, messy review text before any theory. Ask students to name what's being evaluated in each pro/con: they are implicitly doing *aspect-level* opinion identification already. **Callback:** keep this example in mind — reuse it when you reach "Practical definition" (the entity/aspect/sentiment/holder/time quintuple) to show these bullet points are exactly aspect-level opinions about one entity (the book).

2. Conceptual challenges

Interactive (Wooclap) slide — ask students to judge, for each sentence, whether it expresses sentiment and what polarity.

- "*There was an earthquake in Japan*" — a factual/objective statement; no explicit sentiment, even though the event is negative. Good example for the

Issues found and fixed in `Lecture_8.Rmd` while writing these notes

1. **"Regular opinions" definition didn't cover its own "indirect" subtype.** It was defined as "evaluative expressions," but the indirect-opinion example two slides later ("After taking the drug, my pain has gone") has no evaluative language at all. Redefined as "a positive/negative evaluation of a target entity, stated either explicitly (direct) or implied through a stated fact (indirect)."
2. **"Indirect opinion" and "fact-implied opinion" were the same concept under two unconnected names,** introduced separately at the opinion-type level and the sentence level. Relabeled the sentence-level slide's term to "Fact-implied (indirect) opinion" to make the link explicit.
3. **The "Basic Lexicon Approach" answer slide silently used the same "brilliant but boring" pattern that VADER later flags as a known weak point** (naive summation vs the "but" heuristic) with no acknowledgment. Added a limitation bullet that